OSHA Emergency Exit Checklist (29 CFR 1910.36)

Use on routine walk-throughs of exit routes and after changes to layout, storage or doors.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.36

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A, and note which exit route and door each mark refers to.
2. Record each Defect with its location, report it to the person responsible for the building, and recheck the item once it is corrected.
3. Site rules, local fire codes and door or hardware manufacturers' instructions may add checks.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.36: Design and construction requirements for exit routes (Part 1910 Subpart E: Exit Routes and Emergency Planning) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-36-design-construction-exit-routes

SECTION A | Exit doors and locking

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Door opens from inside Ref. 1910.36(d)(1)	Each exit route door opens from inside by hand, with no key, tool or special knowledge needed.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Discharge door locking hardware Ref. 1910.36(d)(1)	Any locking device on an exit discharge door, such as a panic bar, locks only from the outside.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Devices and alarms on exit doors Ref. 1910.36(d)(2)	No device or alarm is fitted that would stop the door being used in an emergency if the device or alarm failed.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Door type from rooms Ref. 1910.36(e)(1)	Each door connecting a room to an exit route is side-hinged.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Door swing Ref. 1910.36(e)(2)	Doors from rooms designed for more than 50 people, or from high hazard areas, swing outward toward the exit.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Fire doors on openings into exits Ref. 1910.36(a)(3)	Each opening into an exit has a self-closing fire door that is shut, or closes automatically when the fire or employee alarm sounds.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Fire door listing Ref. 1910.36(a)(3)	Fire door, frame and hardware are listed or approved by an NRTL.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Width, height and obstructions

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
8	Exit access width Ref. 1910.36(g)(2)	Exit access measures 28 inches (71.1 cm) or more at every point along the route.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Projecting objects Ref. 1910.36(g)(4)	No stored goods, racking, equipment or furniture sticks out into the route far enough to cut its width under the minimum.	☐	☐	☐	
10	Ceiling height Ref. 1910.36(g)(1)	Ceiling along the route is seven feet six inches (2.3 m) or higher.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Width, height and obstructions

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Ceiling projections Ref. 1910.36(g)(1)	No light, duct, pipe or other projection hangs lower than six feet eight inches (2.0 m) above the floor.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Exit and discharge width after a single access Ref. 1910.36(g)(2)	Where one exit access feeds an exit or discharge, the exit and discharge are at least as wide as that access.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Capacity toward the discharge Ref. 1910.36(f)(2)	The route does not narrow or lose capacity anywhere between the work area and the exit discharge.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Number of routes and exit discharge

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
14	Two exit routes Ref. 1910.36(b)(1)	At least two exit routes are available, unless a single route has been assessed as allowing all employees to evacuate safely.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Route separation Ref. 1910.36(b)(1)	Exit routes are as far apart as practical, so fire or smoke blocking one leaves the other usable.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Permanent route Ref. 1910.36(a)(1)	Each exit route is a permanent part of the workplace.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Discharge destination Ref. 1910.36(c)(1)	Each exit discharge leads directly outside or to a street, walkway, refuge area, public way or open space with outside access.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Discharge area size Ref. 1910.36(c)(2)	The area at the end of the discharge is large enough for the occupants likely to use that route.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Stairs past the discharge level Ref. 1910.36(c)(3)	Exit stairs that continue beyond the discharge level are interrupted there by a door, partition or other means that clearly shows the way out.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Outdoor exit routes

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
20	Outdoor height and width Ref. 1910.36(h)	Outdoor route meets the same minimum height and width as an indoor exit route.	☐	☐	☐	
21	Guardrails Ref. 1910.36(h)(1)	Guardrails protect unenclosed sides wherever a fall hazard exists.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Snow and ice Ref. 1910.36(h)(2)	Route is covered where snow or ice is likely to build up, or accumulation is removed before it becomes a slipping hazard.	☐	☐	☐	
23	Walkway surface Ref. 1910.36(h)(3)	Route is reasonably straight, with smooth, solid, substantially level walkways.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Dead-ends Ref. 1910.36(h)(4)	No dead-end on the route is longer than 20 feet (6.2 m).	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME